

JKBOSE 2026

CLASS 11TH

ADVENTURE

LECTURE-3

ENGLISH

HUSSAIN SIR



Topics To Covered

- 1 ... Lec.03 - (Detailed explanation)
Summary and Textual questions.
- 2 ...
- 3 ...
- 4 ...

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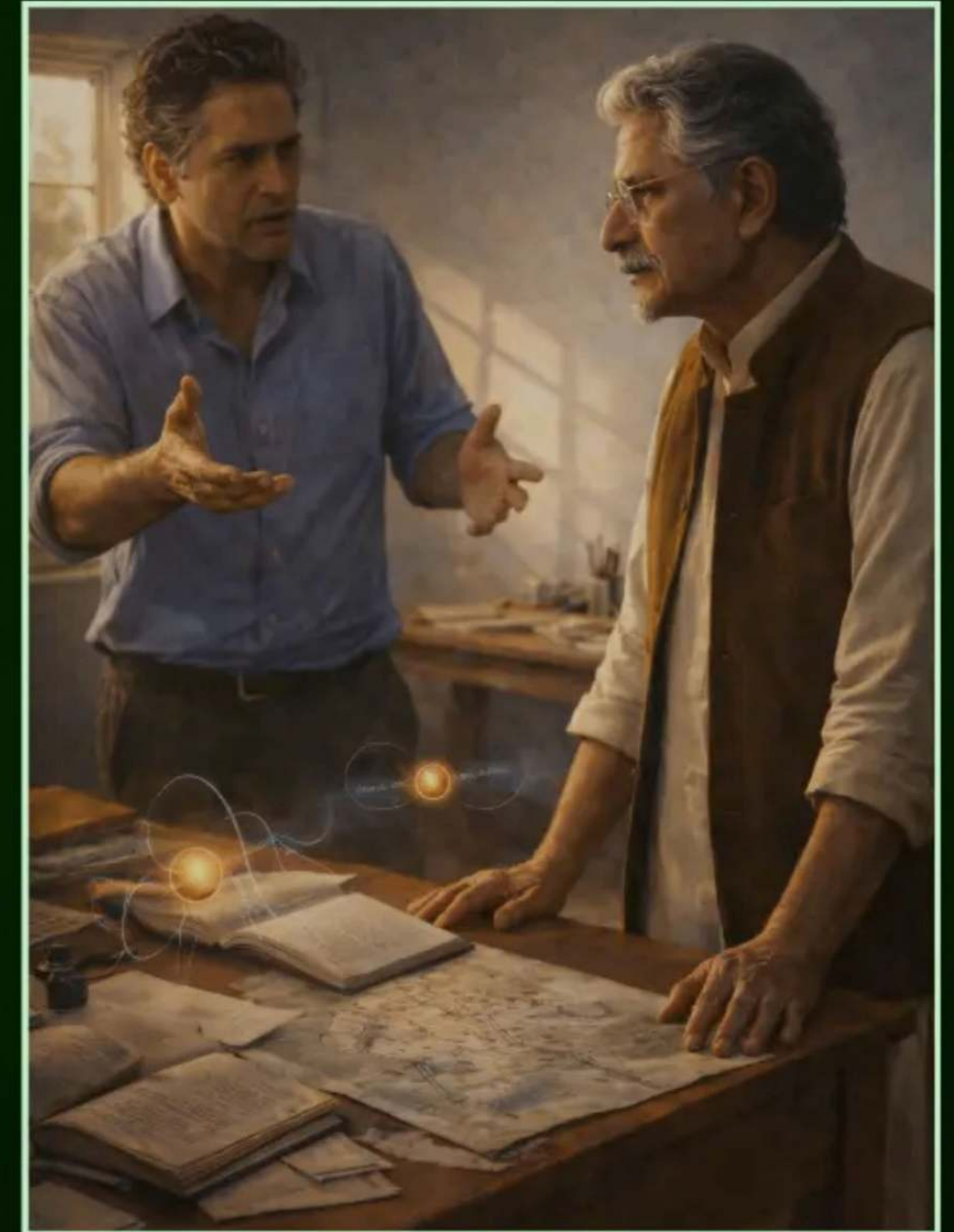
“I take issue with you there. In fact, that brings me to my second point which you may find strange; but please hear me out,” Rajendra said.

Gangadharpant listened expectantly as Rajendra continued. “What do we mean by reality? We experience it directly with our senses or indirectly via instruments. But is it limited to what we see? Does it have other manifestations?”



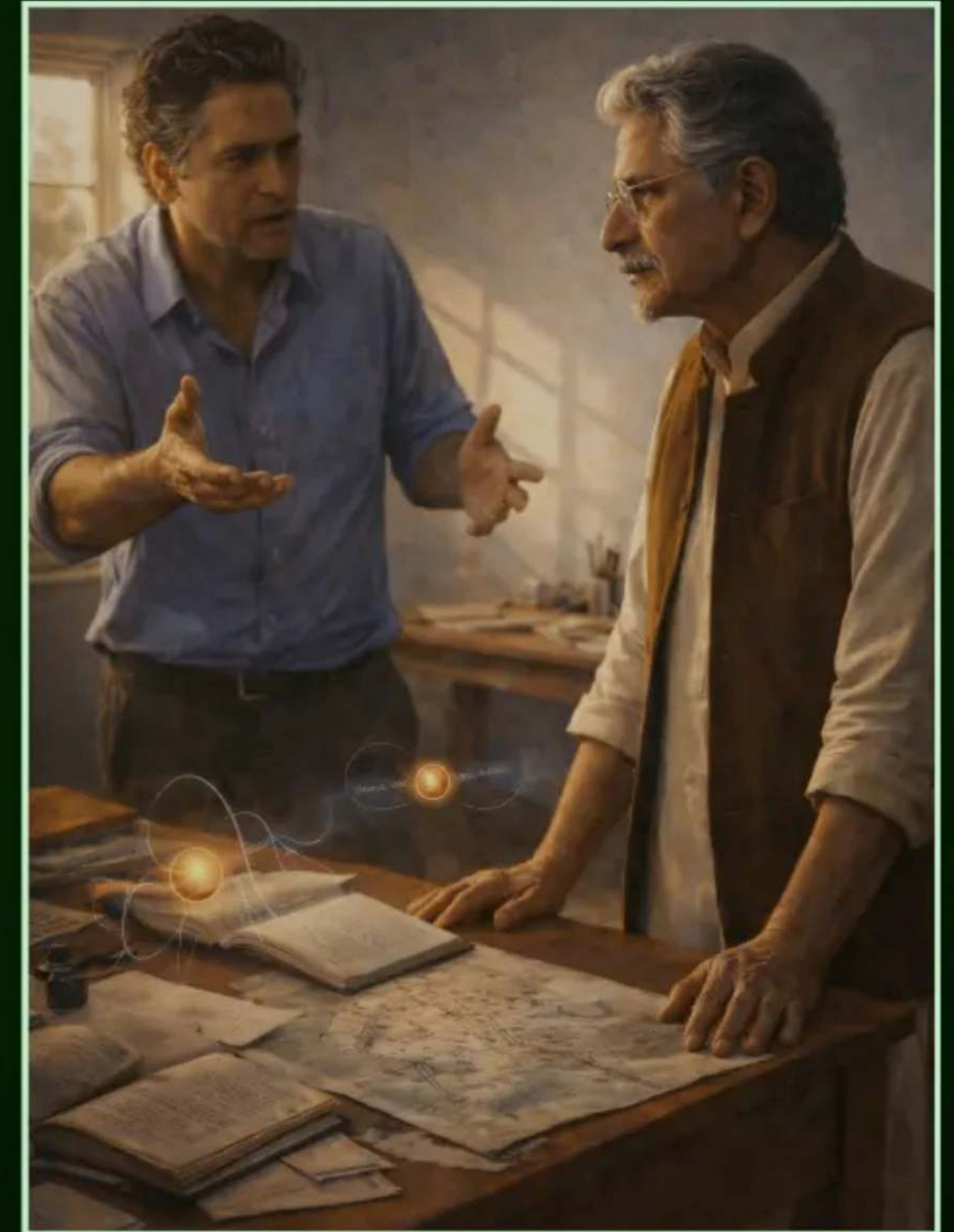
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“That reality may not be unique has been found from experiments on very small systems—of atoms and their constituent particles. When dealing with such systems the physicist discovered something startling. The behaviour of these systems cannot be predicted definitively even if all the physical laws governing those systems are known.



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“Take an example. I fire an electron from a source. Where will it go? If I fire a bullet from a gun in a given direction at a given speed, I know where it will be at a later time. But I cannot make such an assertion for the electron. It may be here, there, anywhere. I can at best quote odds for it being found in a specified location at a specified time.”

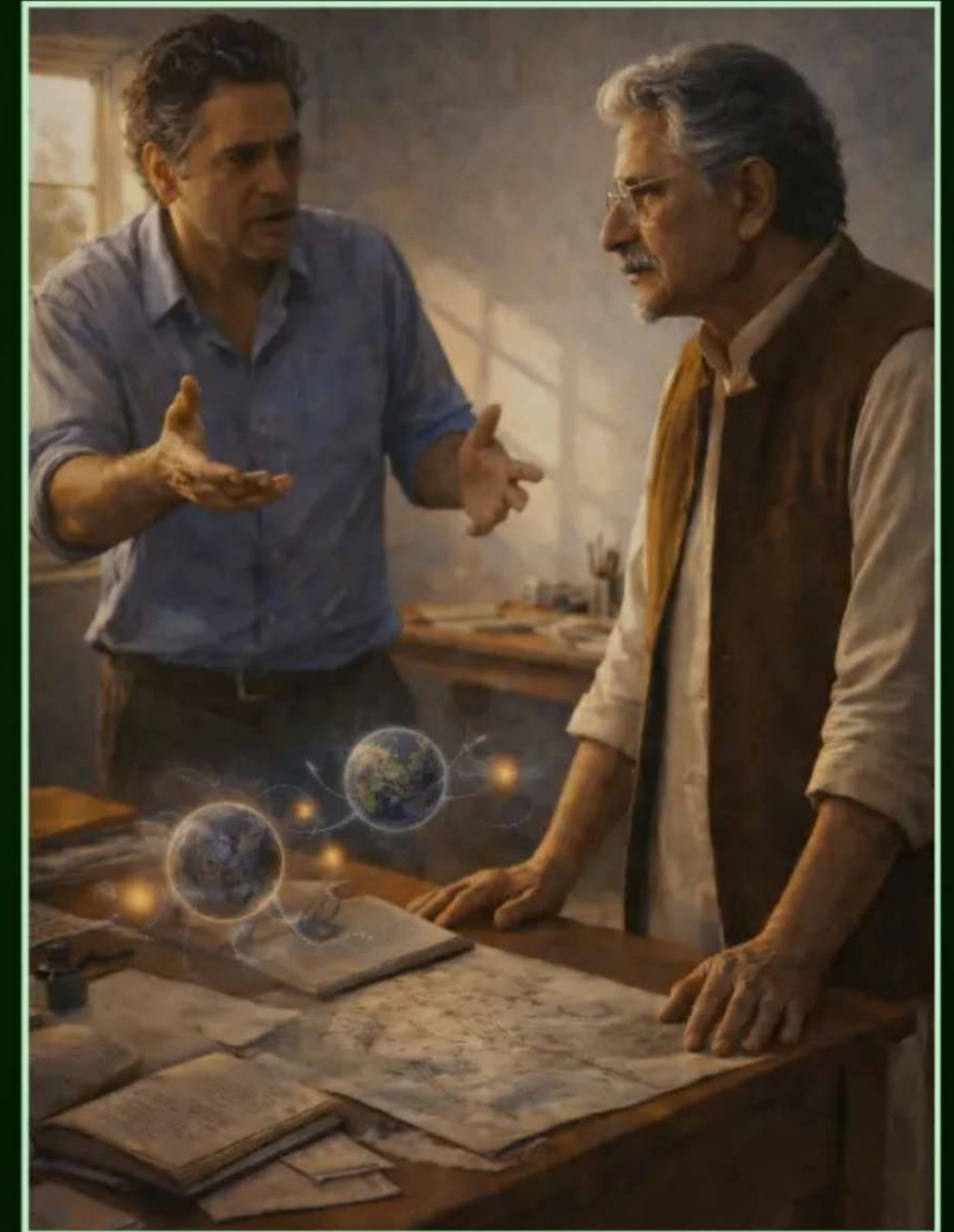


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“The lack of determinism in quantum theory! Even an ignoramus historian like me has heard of it,” Professor Gaitonde said.

“So, imagine many world pictures. In one world the electron is found here, in another it is over there. In yet another it is in a still different location. Once the observer finds where it is, we know which world we are talking about. But all those alternative worlds could exist just the same.” Rajendra paused to marshal his thoughts.



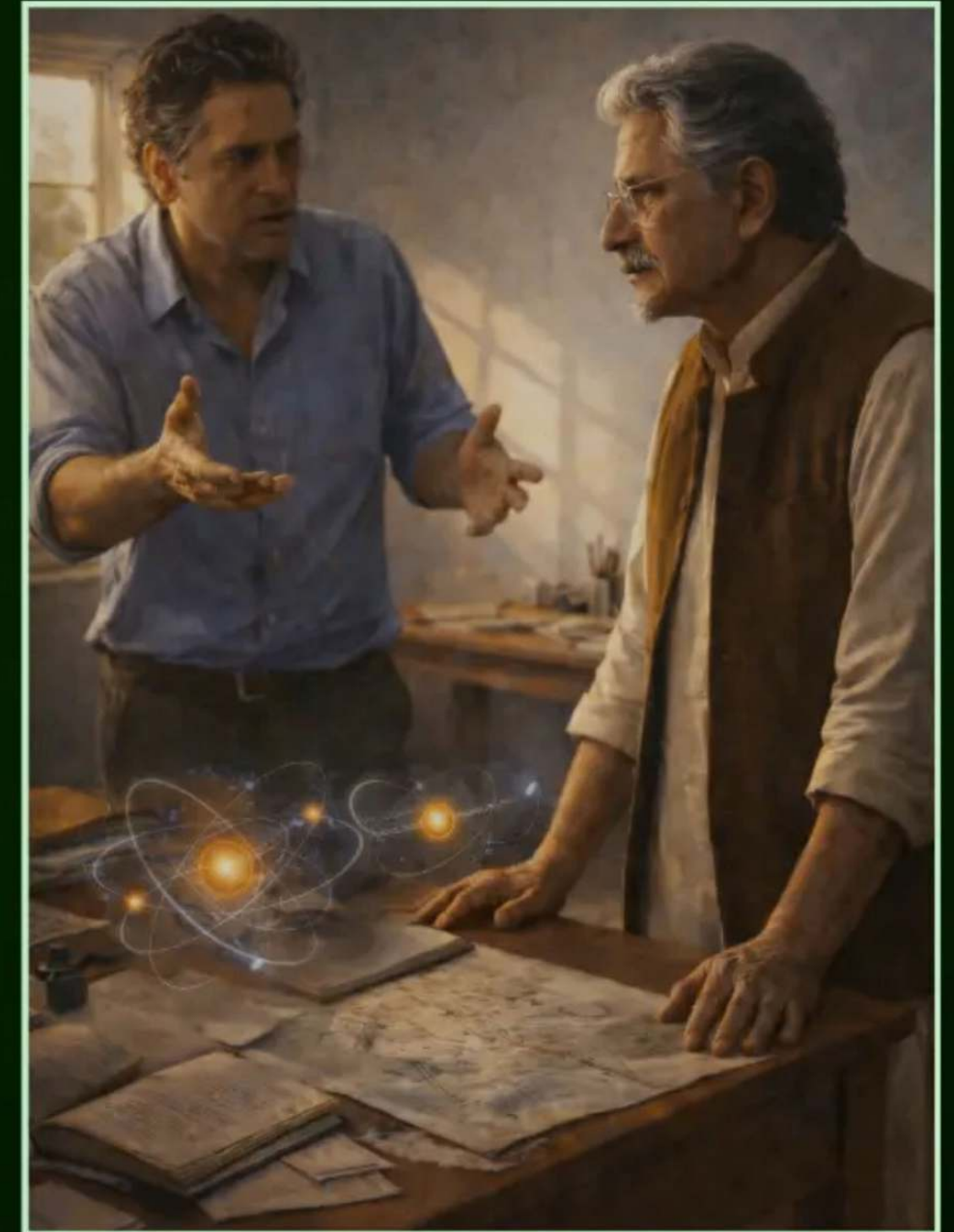
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“But is there any contact between those many worlds?” Professor Gaitonde asked.

“Yes and no! Imagine two worlds, for example. In both an electron is orbiting the nucleus of an atom...”

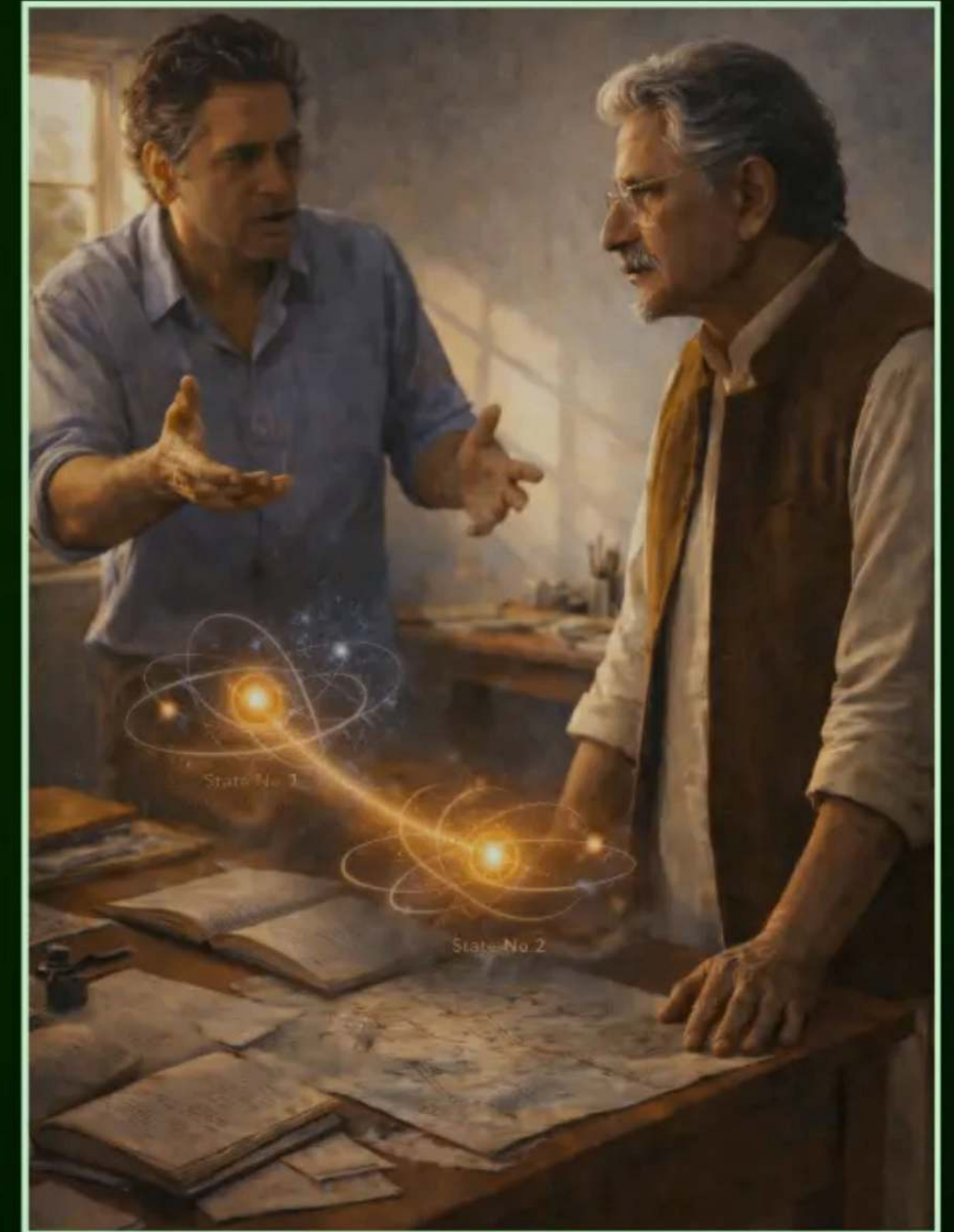
“Like planets around the sun...” Gangadharpant interjected.



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“Not quite. We know the ^{exact Path} precise trajectory of the planet. The electron could be orbiting in any of a large number of specified states. These states may be used to identify the world. In state no.1 we have the electron in a state of higher energy. In state no.2 it is in a state of lower energy. It can make a jump from high to low energy and send out a pulse of radiation. Or a pulse of radiation can knock it out of state no.2 into state no.1. Such ^{Change} transitions are common in microscopic systems. What if it happened on a macroscopic level?” Rajendra said.



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“I get you! You are suggesting that I made a transition from one world to another and back again?” Gangadharpant asked.

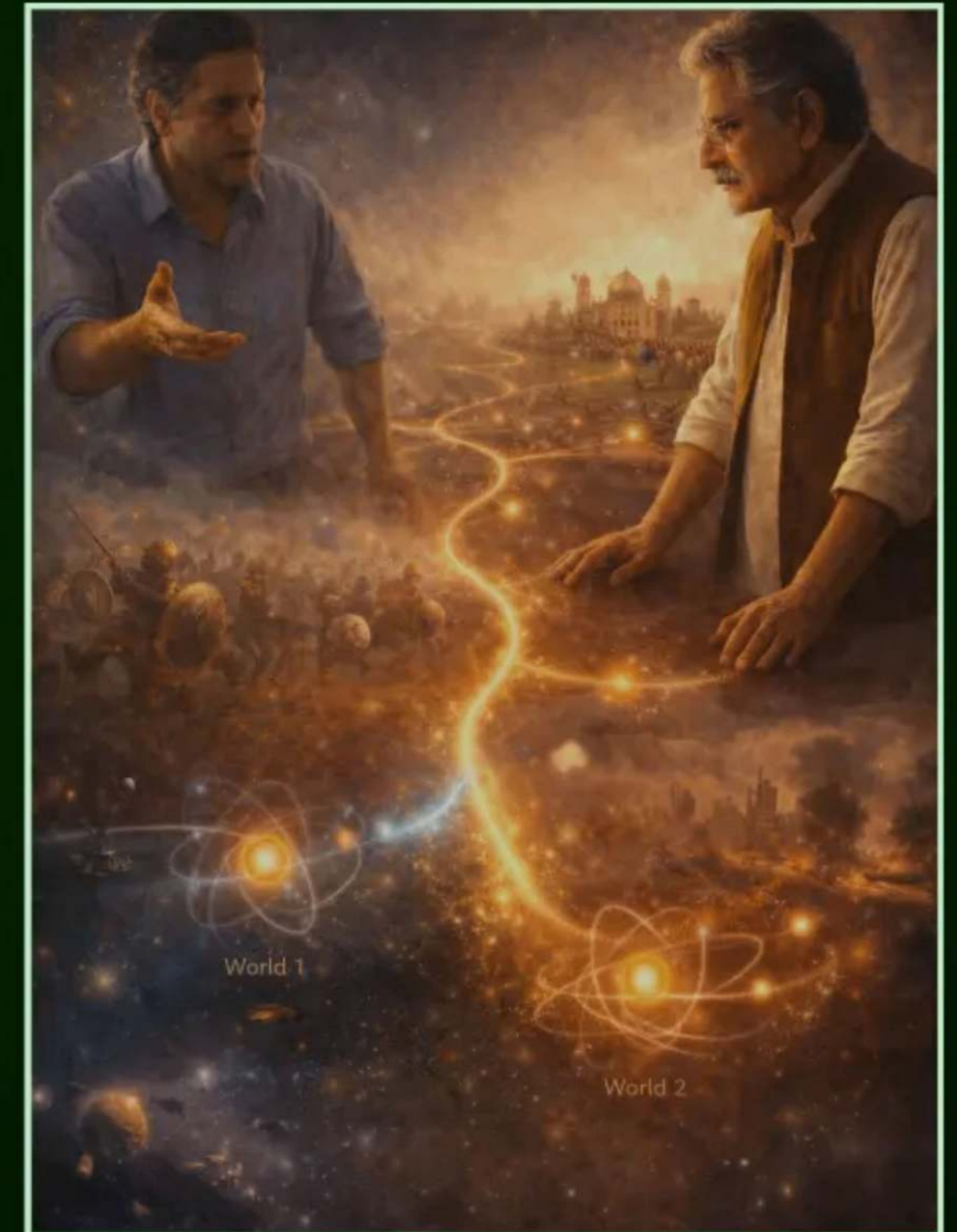
“Fantastic though it seems, this is the only explanation I can offer. My theory is that catastrophic situations offer radically different alternatives for the world to proceed. It seems that so far as reality is concerned all alternatives are viable but the observer can experience only one of them at a time.



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“By making a transition, you were able to experience two worlds although one at a time. The one you live in now and the one where you spent two days. One has the history we know, the other a different history. The separation or bifurcation took place in the Battle of Panipat. You neither travelled to the past nor to the future. You were in the present but experiencing a different world. Of course, by the same token there must be many more different worlds arising out of bifurcations at different points of time.”



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As Rajendra concluded, Gangadharpant asked the question that was beginning to bother him most. “But why did I make the transition?”

“If I knew the answer I would solve a great problem.

Unfortunately, there are many unsolved questions in science and this is one of them. But that does not stop me from guessing.” Rajendra smiled and proceeded, “You need some interaction to cause a transition. Perhaps, at the time of the collision you were thinking about the catastrophe theory and its role in wars. Maybe you were wondering about the Battle of Panipat. Perhaps, the neurons in your brain acted as a trigger.”

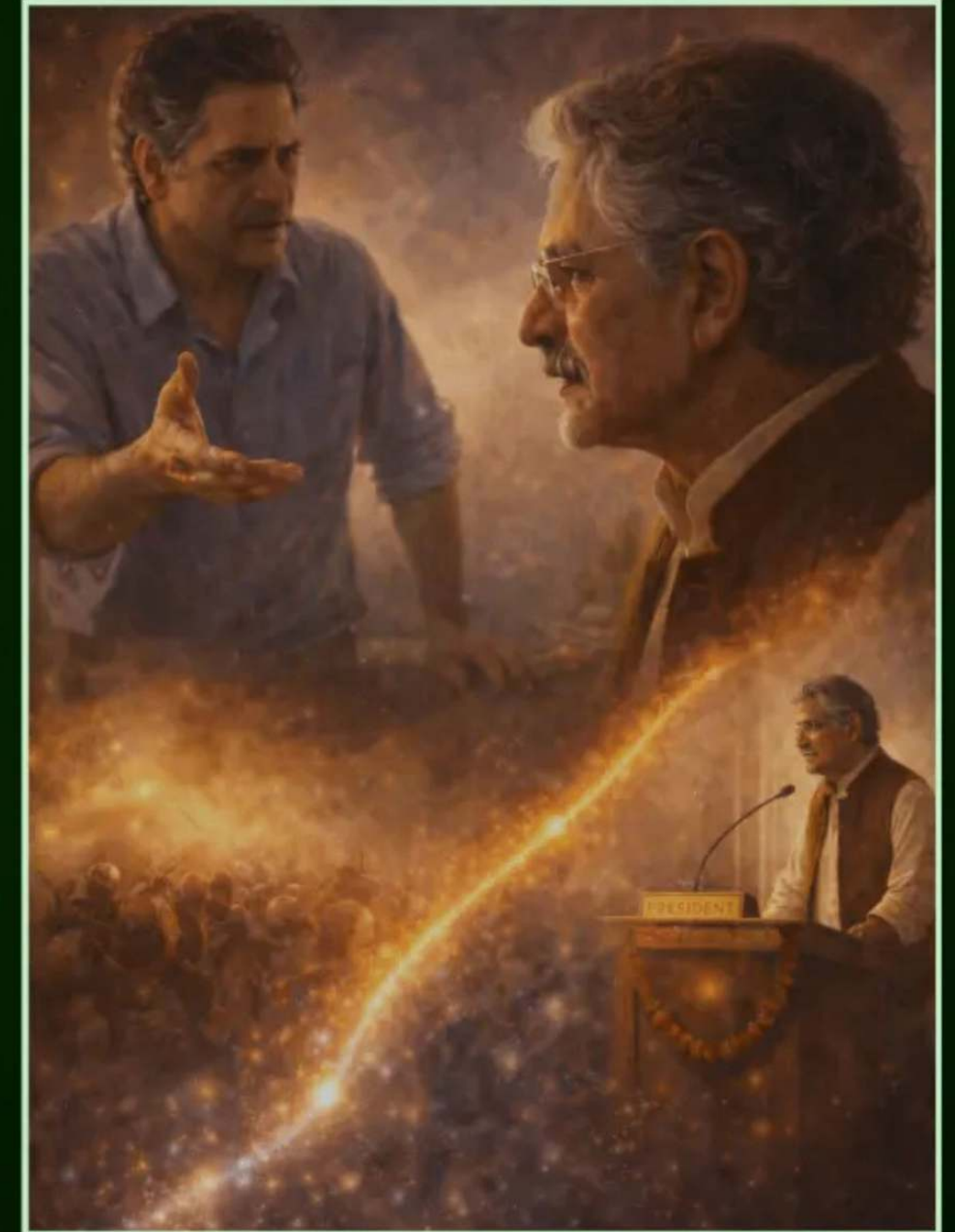


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“A good guess. I was indeed wondering what course history would have taken if the result of the battle had gone the other way,” Professor Gaitonde said.

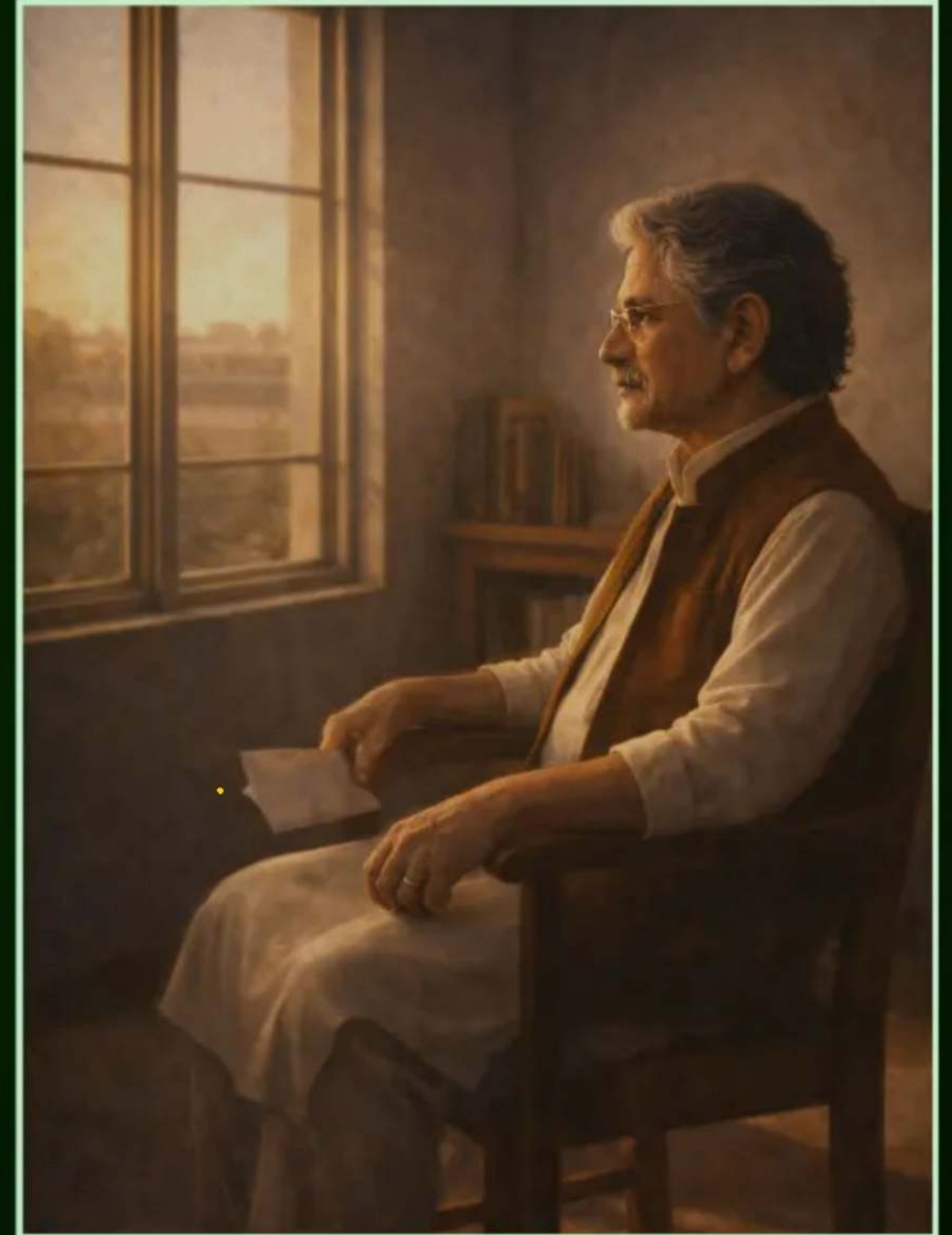
“That was going to be the topic of my thousandth presidential address.” – 1000th → lecture.

“Now you are in the happy position of recounting your real life experience rather than just speculating,” Rajendra laughed. But Gangadharpant was grave.



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“No, Rajendra, my thousandth address was made on the Azad Maidan when I was so rudely interrupted. No. The Professor Gaitonde who disappeared while defending his chair on the platform will now never be seen presiding at another meeting — I have conveyed my regrets to the organisers of the Panipat seminar.”



QUESTION



What theory does Rajendra Deshpande use to explain Gaitonde's experience?

- 1 Evolution theory
- 2 Theory of Relativity
- 3 Catastrophe theory and quantum theory 
- 4 String theory

QUESTION



What is meant by 'Catastrophe' in Catastrophe Theory?

- 1 Natural disasters
- 2 A war
- 3 A sudden shift due to small changes 
- 4 Explosion of planets

QUESTION



How does the alternate India appear to Professor Gaitonde?

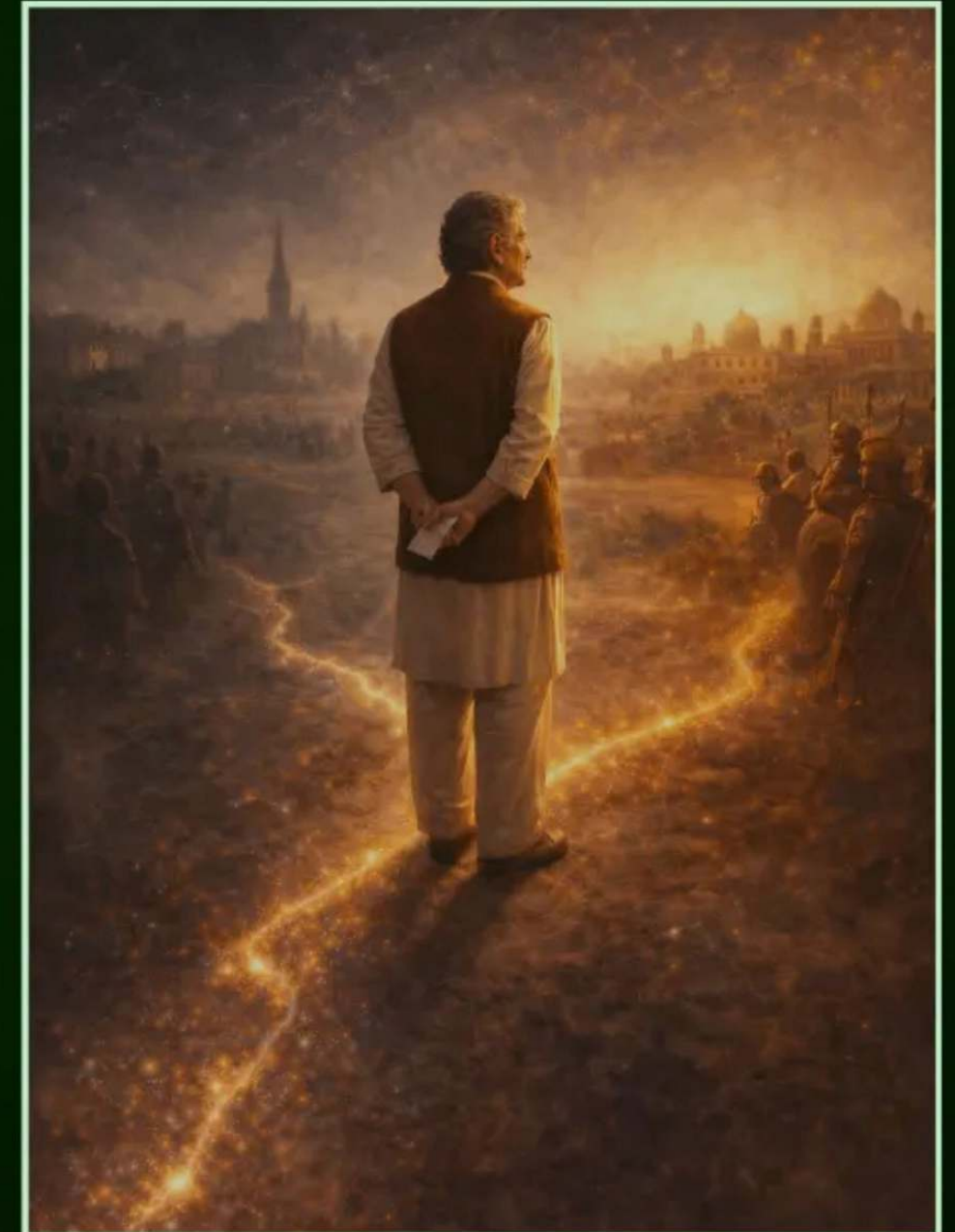
- 1 Independent, confident, and progressive 
- 2 Superstitious and backward
- 3 Poor and colonized
- 4 Under military rule

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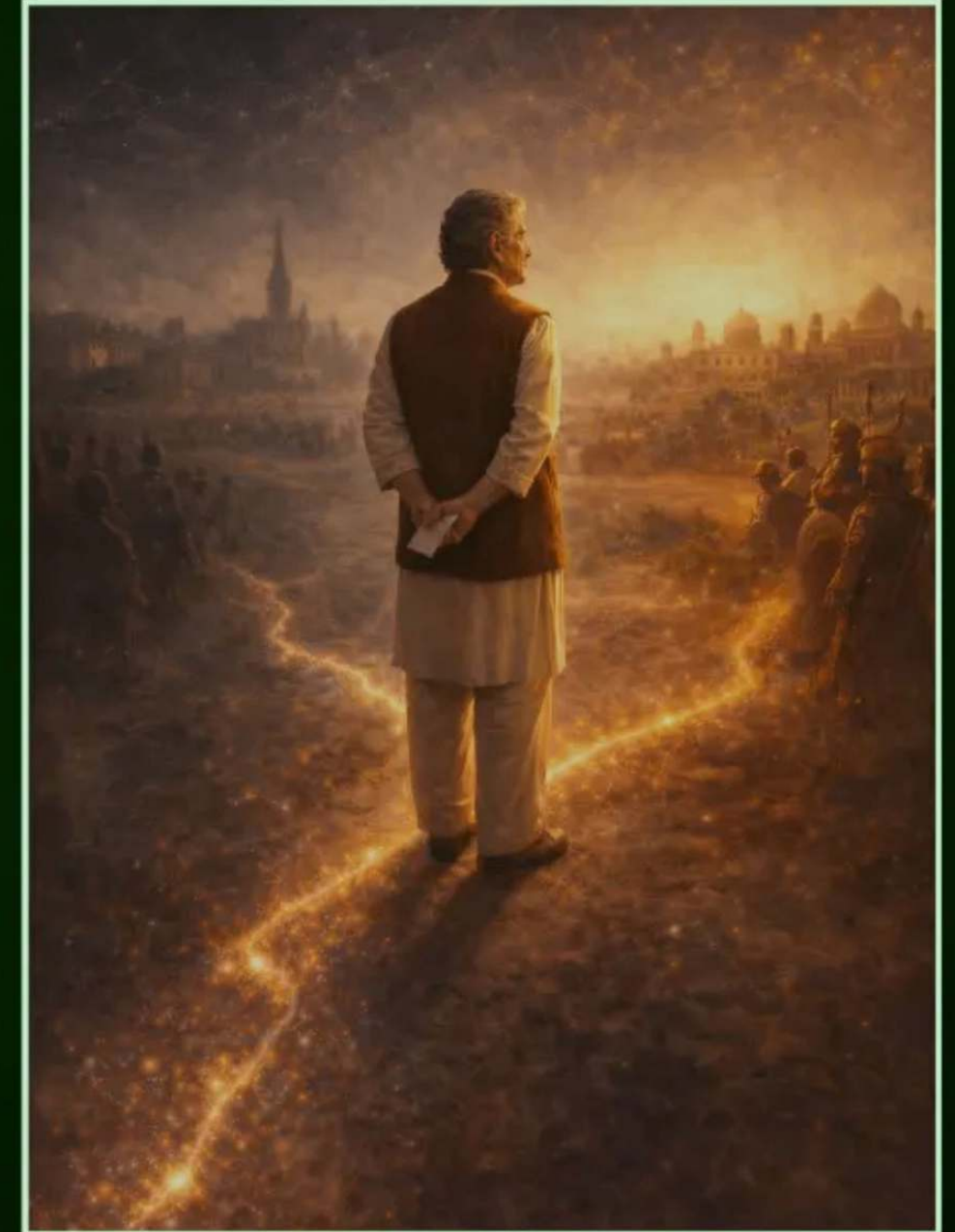
Chapter Summary

"The Adventure" by Jayant Narlikar is a fascinating story that merges science, history, and imagination. It revolves around Professor Gangadhar pant Gaitonde, a renowned historian who experiences a strange and inexplicable event that leads him to an alternate version of Indian history. As he prepares to write the last chapter of a book on the Battle of Panipat, he becomes obsessed with a single question:



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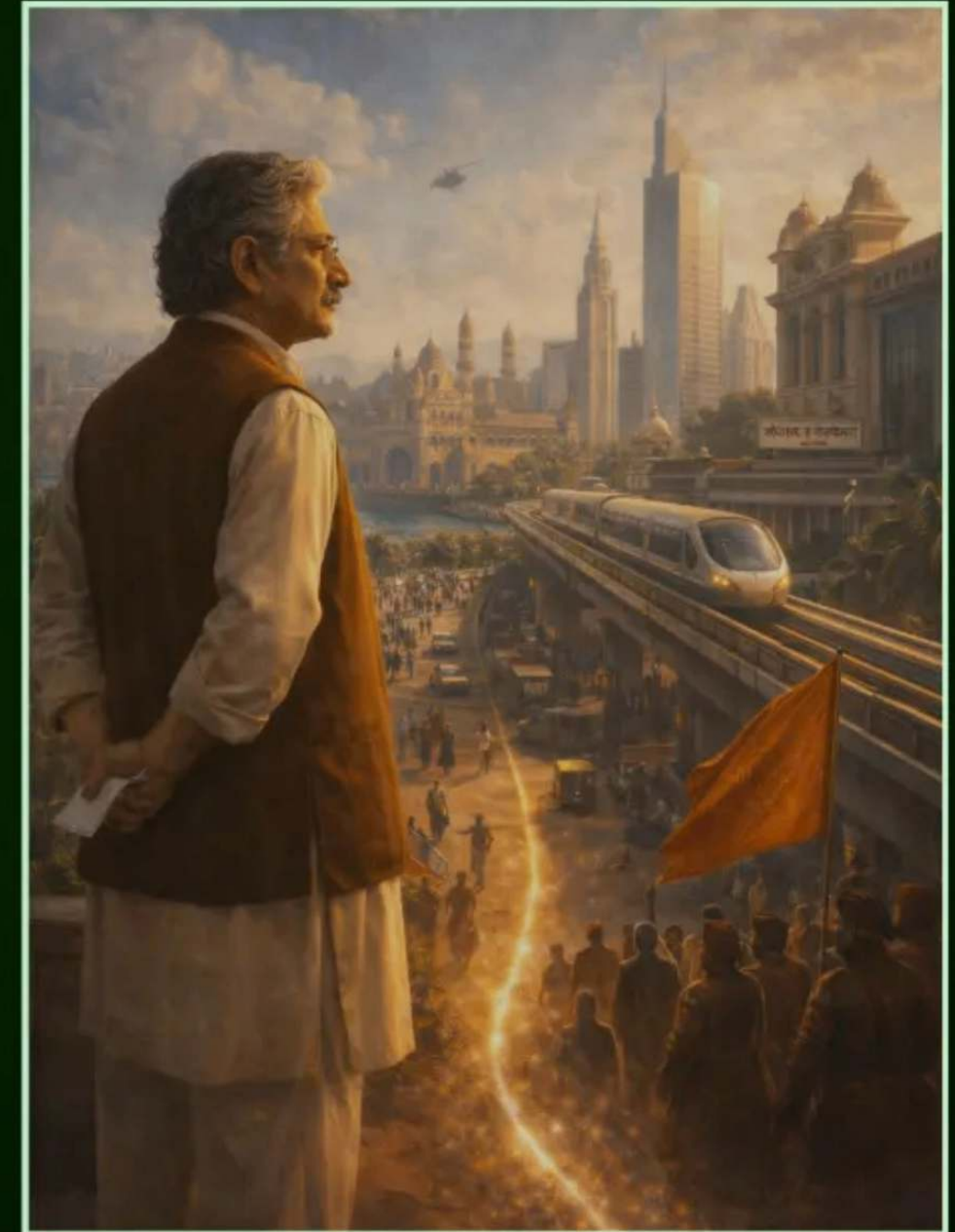
What would have happened if the Marathas had won the battle against Ahmad Shah Abdali in 1761? In our known history, the Marathas lost, which led to a decline in Indian power and eventually paved the way for British colonization. But Gaitonde wonders—could history have taken a different path?



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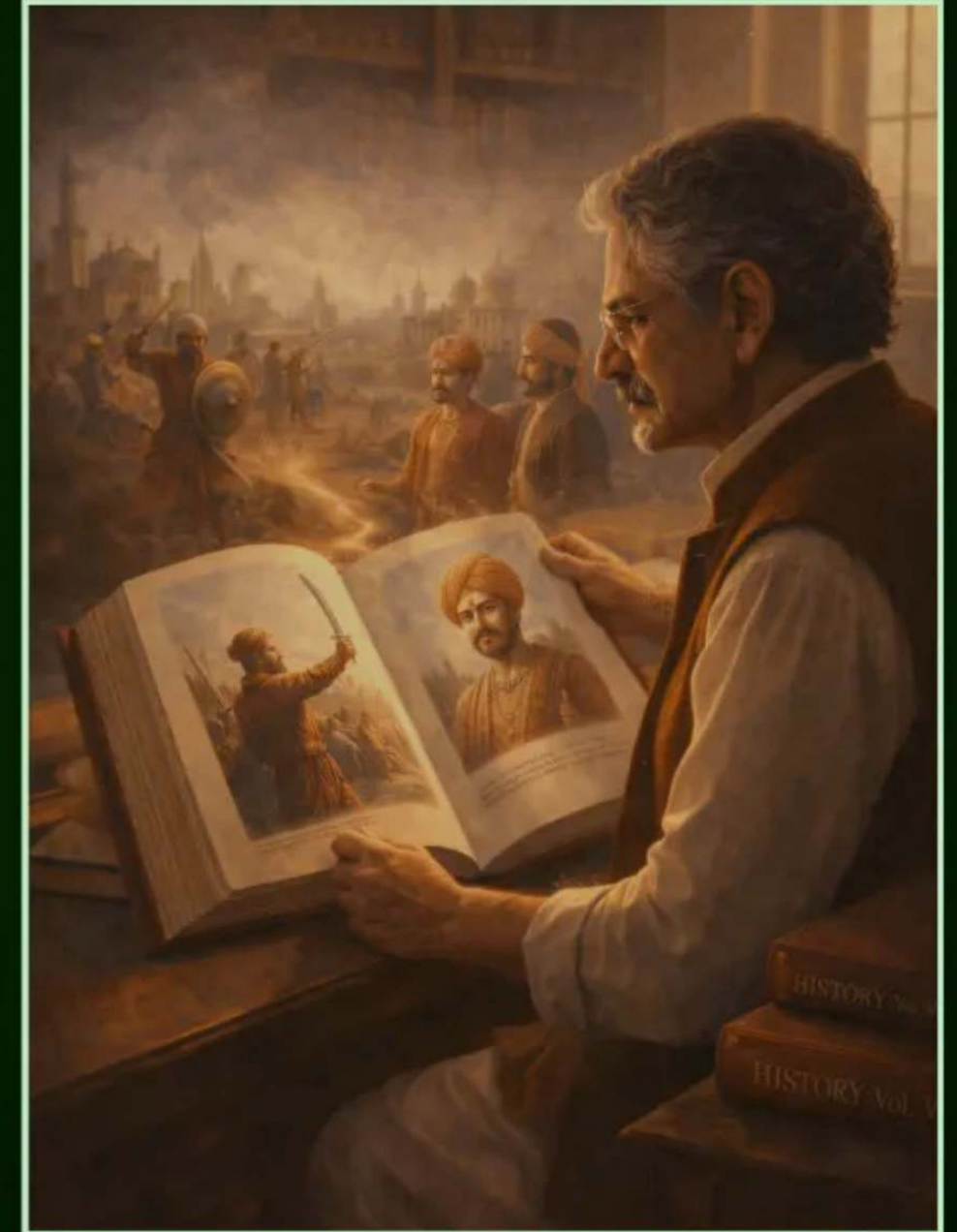


Driven by this thought, Gaitonde embarks on a journey to Bombay (now Mumbai). On the way, he has a peculiar experience—he finds himself in a world that resembles his own but is fundamentally different. In this world, India was never colonized by the British. The country is modern, clean, and efficiently governed. He notices that the people around him are confident and patriotic, and there is a strong emphasis on self-reliance and scientific development. In this version of India, the Marathas had won the Battle of Panipat, unified the country, and created a stable and progressive society that resisted foreign domination.



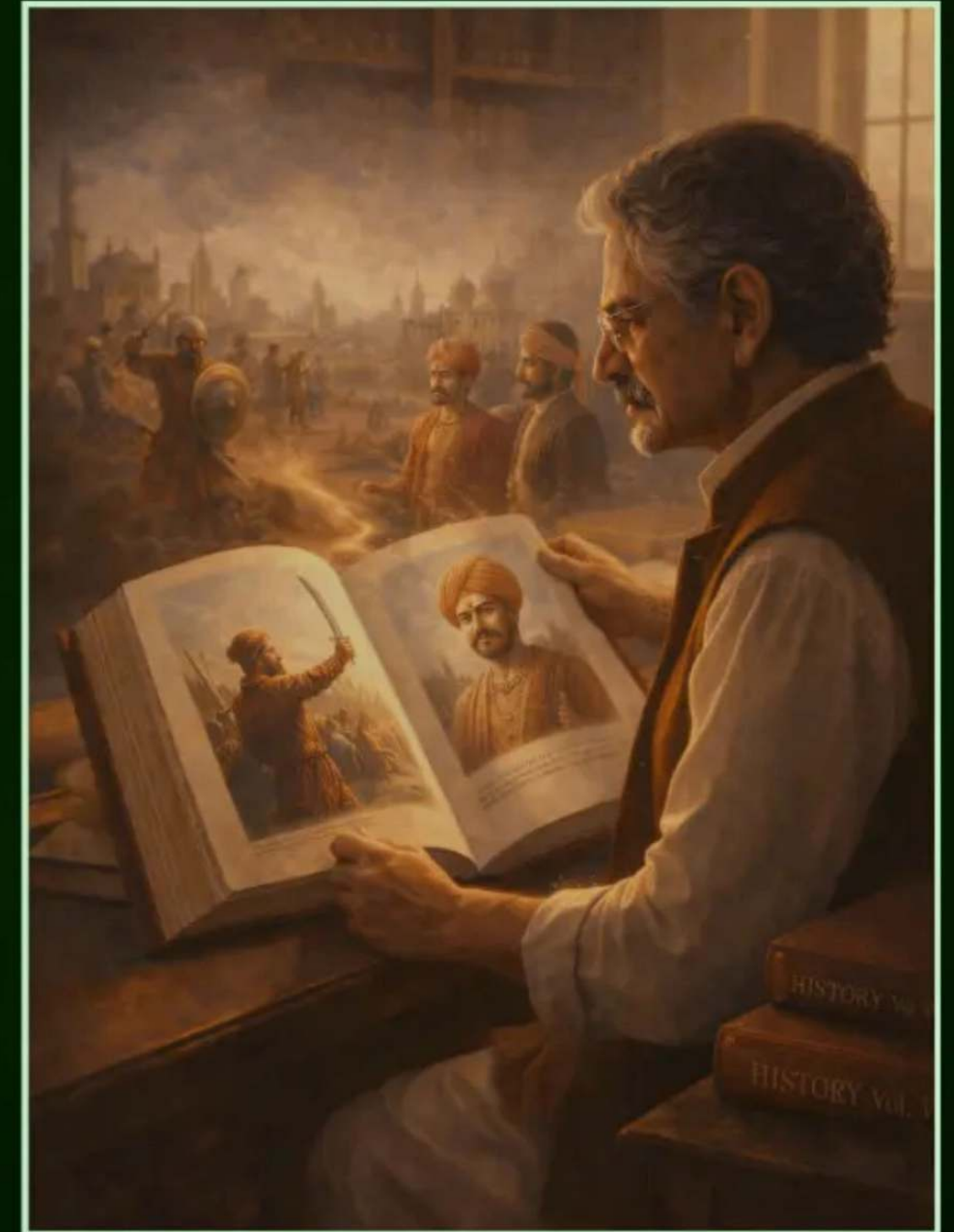
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As Gaitonde explores this unfamiliar but fascinating world, he comes across a library and begins reading historical records. To his amazement, the first four volumes of the history books match exactly with the history he knows. However, the fifth volume presents an entirely different story. According to this account, after their victory at Panipat, the Marathas continued to consolidate power and build a united India. Leaders like Vishwasrao, who had died in the known history, survived in this version and went on to play a significant role in nation-building.



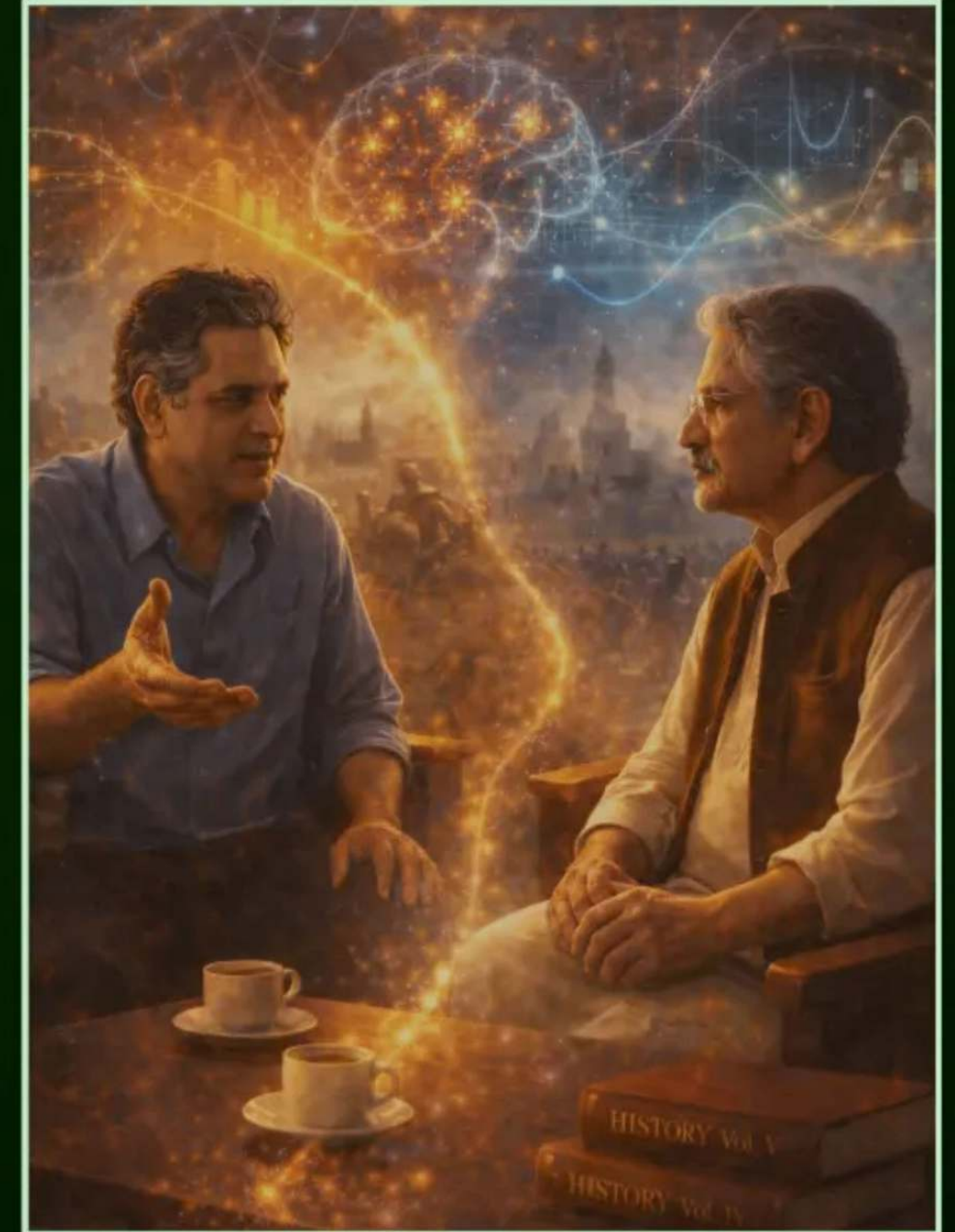
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The British attempted to expand their influence but were unable to do so because India was already politically strong and economically stable.



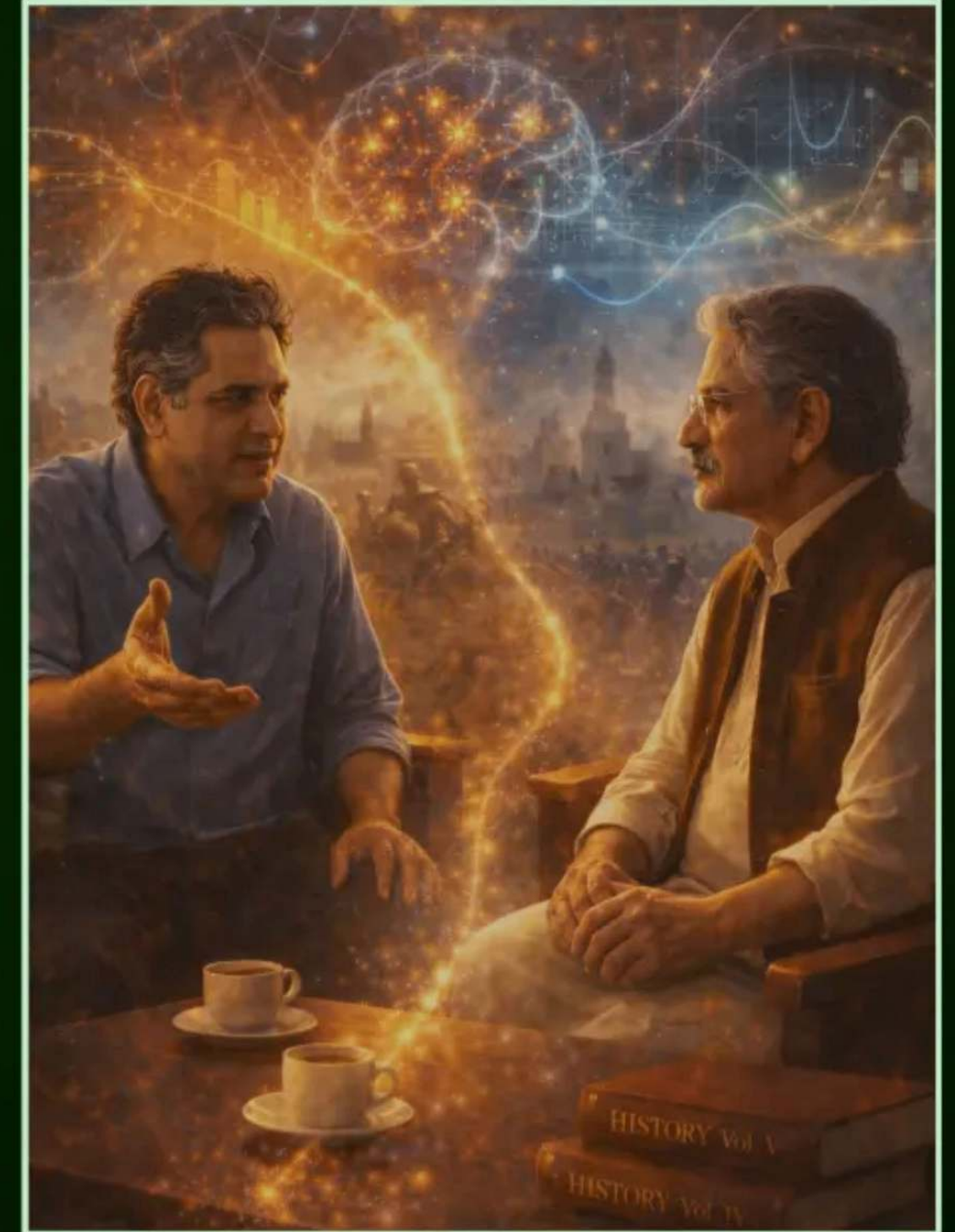
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He Just when Gaitonde is beginning to understand this alternative timeline, he finds himself back in the familiar world. Confused and shaken, he meets his friend Rajendra Deshpande, a scientist, and shares his extraordinary experience. Rajendra listens carefully and offers a scientific explanation. He explains that Gaitonde may have temporarily entered a parallel world—a concept supported by theories in modern physics. According to the Catastrophe Theory, a small change in circumstances can lead to a sudden and dramatic shift in outcomes.



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In this case, if a different decision had been taken in the Battle of Panipat, the result would have drastically altered the course of Indian history. Rajendra also refers to Quantum Theory, particularly the idea of superposition, which suggests that multiple outcomes can exist simultaneously. Gaitonde, due to his intense mental engagement with the subject, might have subconsciously crossed into one such alternate reality.



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Through this imaginative yet scientifically grounded story, Jayant Narlikar challenges the idea that history is fixed. He proposes that every major event carries within it the possibility of multiple outcomes, and what we consider reality might just be one of many alternatives. The story encourages readers to think about how different choices in the past could have shaped a different present. "The Adventure" is not just about history or science—it's a reflection on the power of human thought, the mysteries of the universe, and the endless possibilities that lie beyond our understanding.



QUESTION



Tick the statements that are true:

(A) **The story is an account of real events.**

False: It is a work of fiction based on the concept of alternate history and theoretical physics 

(B) **The story hinges on a particular historical event.**

True: The story revolves around the outcome of the Battle of Panipat and how it could have changed Indian history.

(C) **Rajendra Deshpande was a historian.**

False: Rajendra is portrayed as a physicist, not a historian.

(D) **The places mentioned in the story are all imaginary.**

False: Places like Pune, Mumbai, and Azad Maidan are real locations.

(E) **The story tries to relate history to science.**

True: It combines history with concepts from modern science, especially quantum theory and catastrophe theory.

QUESTION



"Gangadharpant could not help comparing the country he knew with what he was witnessing around him."

ANSWER:

This shows Professor Gaitonde's reaction when he finds himself in an alternate India that had not been colonized by the British. He mentally compares the real history he knows with the advanced and independent India he is witnessing. He is both amazed and confused by the stark differences.

QUESTION

"The lack of determinism in quantum theory!"

ANSWER:

This statement reflects a key idea from quantum physics that outcomes are not always predictable or fixed (unlike classical physics). Rajendra uses this to explain how multiple realities or histories could exist at the same time, and how Gaitonde might have experienced one such alternative possibility.

QUESTION



"You need some interaction to cause a transition."

ANSWER:

Rajendra says this to explain that to move from one state or reality to another, some physical or mental interaction is needed. In Professor Gaitonde's case, the collision with the truck might have been the trigger that caused his mind to transition into a parallel world.

QUESTION



"You have obviously passed through the catastrophic experience – but you are back."

ANSWER:

Rajendra acknowledges that Professor Gaitonde did experience a shift into another world, but he has now returned to his original reality. The word "catastrophic" again refers to the sudden shift in state as explained by the catastrophe theory.

Homework



Make notes and print & show them
in Community.

Thank
You